Japan With Kids

Family Trip Checklist & Planner · a free guide from littletabi.com · 2026

Everything we wish we'd known before travelling around Japan with young kids - a print-friendly checklist, the facts that actually matter in 2026, and a gentle 7-day Tokyo plan. Tick the boxes as you pack.

Documents & money

☐ Passports valid 6+ months; check if your nationality needs a visa
☐ Print or screenshot hotel bookings, flights and pre-booked tickets
☐ Some yen cash for day one (small shops & shrines are often cash-only)
☐ Travel / health insurance that covers your children
☐ A tap-card plan: Suica, PASMO or ICOCA (or Welcome Suica for visitors)
☐ A photo of each child + your hotel address, in case you get separated

Health & safety

☐ Regular medicines in original packaging + a small first-aid kit
☐ Your child's usual fever / pain medicine - brands differ in Japan
☐ Note the nearest clinic & pharmacy to your hotel
☐ Save the emergency numbers: 119 (ambulance / fire), 110 (police)
☐ For allergies: a translated allergy card to show at restaurants
☐ A hat, sunscreen and hand sanitiser in your day bag

Packing for kids

☐ A day or two of diapers / formula, then buy locally - it's everywhere
☐ A lightweight, foldable stroller or a carrier for crowded stations
☐ Plane snacks and something for the ‘are we there yet’ moments
☐ Refillable water bottles and a change of clothes in the day bag
☐ Season-right layers (summers hot & humid; winters cold but mild)
☐ A familiar comfort toy for naps and long train rides

Getting around & luggage

☐ Big suitcases on the Shinkansen: bags 160–250 cm (length+width+height) need a free advance ‘oversized baggage’ seat reservation
☐ Consider luggage forwarding (takuhaibin) hotel-to-hotel, or day luggage storage - station coin lockers fill up fast, especially large ones
☐ Kids’ train fares: children aged 6–11 pay about half; under 6 usually ride free (see the fact box overleaf)

Tech & connectivity

☐ Sort an eSIM or pocket Wi-Fi before you land (maps + translation)
☐ Download offline maps and a translation language pack
☐ Power bank for long park days
☐ The right plug: Japan is Type A, 100 V

Good-to-know facts for 2026

We keep these on one page because they change and they trip families up. Checked against official sources on 2026-07-07 - always confirm before you go.

Disney rental strollers

At Tokyo Disneyland & DisneySea, rental strollers are for children who can sit unassisted (about 7 months+), up to 100 cm tall and up to 15 kg.

Bring your own if your child is bigger. Confirm on the official Tokyo Disney Resort site.

Kids' train fares (JR)

Children aged 6–11 pay half the adult fare (Green / sleeper tickets are full price). Under 6 ride free - up to two under-6s per paying adult in non-reserved seats.

Source: JR-Central. Confirm on the official site.

Shinkansen with big suitcases

On the Tokaido / Sanyo / Kyushu Shinkansen, baggage of 160–250 cm total (L+W+H) needs a free 'oversized baggage' seat reservation. Over 250 cm isn't allowed.

Reserve when you book your seat. Confirm on the official site.

Tax-free shopping

Spend at least 5,000 yen (pre-tax) at one store on the same day. From 1 Nov 2026, Japan moves to a refund method: pay the tax-included price and claim the refund at the airport.

Bring your passport. Confirm current rules on official sources.

A gentle 7-day Tokyo plan (with young kids)

One big thing a day, buffers for naps and meltdowns, and plenty of snack breaks. Pre-book anything with timed entry.

Day 1 - Arrive & settle

Land, pick up IC cards, check in, then a gentle neighbourhood stroll and a konbini (convenience-store) dinner. Kid tip: early night to beat jet lag - don't overplan day one.

Day 2 - Asakusa & the river

Senso-ji temple and snacks along Nakamise, then an easy Sumida River boat (stroller-friendly and very visual). Rainy day: Sumida Aquarium at Tokyo Skytree.

Day 3 - Ueno

Ueno Zoo and the wide park to run around; pick just one museum (the Nature & Science museum is a hit). Leave a buffer for naps.

Day 4 - teamLab & the bay

Book teamLab Planets tickets ahead. Afternoon around Odaiba / Miraikan. Keep it light after a big morning.

Day 5 - Tokyo Disneyland or DisneySea

One park, one day. Rent a stroller at the gate (up to 100 cm / 15 kg). Plan around a midday rest; pre-book any paid ride reservations in the official app.

Day 6 - Shibuya / Harajuku slow day

The Scramble Crossing, a themed cafe, gacha machines and Yoyogi Park. Short hops and lots of snack breaks.

Day 7 - Flex & fly

A buffer morning, last-minute (tax-free) shopping, luggage forwarding or storage, and off to the airport early.

Going beyond Tokyo? Our full 10-day Tokyo–Kyoto–Osaka family itinerary is free on the site.

Handy references

In an emergency Dial 119 for ambulance / fire and 110 for police - free from any phone, and you can ask for an English-speaking operator. Japan also has a free 24-hour visitor hotline run by JNTO (search ‘JNTO Japan Visitor Hotline’).

A few useful phrases

English	Say it (romaji)	日本語
Does this contain [X]?	Kore ni [X] wa haitte imasu ka?	**これに〇〇は入っていますか？**
My child has a food allergy.	Kodomo ni shokumotsu-arerugii ga arimasu.	**子どもに食物アレルギーがあります。**
Where is the nearest toilet?	Ichiban chikai toire wa doko desu ka?	**一番近いトイレはどこですか？**
Is there a nursing / baby room?	Jugyuushitsu wa arimasu ka?	**授乳室はありますか？**
Help, please!	Tasukete kudasai!	**助けてください！**
Thank you!	Arigatou gozaimasu!	**ありがとうございます！**

Free guides to explore next

→ Make a printable allergy card	littletabi.com/tools/allergy-card
→ Full family packing list	littletabi.com/japan-packing-list-for-families-2026-kids-travel-essentials
→ 10-day Tokyo-Kyoto-Osaka itinerary	littletabi.com/japan-family-itinerary-tokyo-kyoto-osaka-with-young-children
→ Best family hotels in Tokyo	littletabi.com/best-family-hotels-tokyo-connecting-rooms
→ Family eSIMs compared	littletabi.com/japan-esim-for-families-compared
→ Build a free trip plan	littletabi.com/plan

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